AJOURNÉ INTO MUSIC / AN ORIGINAL REFERENCE

The Interval Palette

Twelve semitone steps. Thirteen landmarks. A world of musical choices.

One-octave chart: every example holds C4 as its starting note. Read the pitch facts, then choose your own colors.

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0 Perfect unison — P1

Example: C4 → C4

focused · unified · still

doubling · one-pitch texture



1 Minor second — m2

Example: C4 → D♭4

close · rubbing · delicate

neighbor motion · chromatic color



2 Major second — M2

Example: C4 → D4

stepping · airy · hovering

melodic steps · suspended textures



3 Minor third — m3

Example: C4 → E♭4

intimate · shaded · lyrical

melodic skips · minor harmony



4 Major third — M3

Example: C4 → E4

clear · warm · glowing

major harmony · familiar dyad



5 Perfect fourth — P4

Example: C4 → F4

open · poised · suspended

drones · held/upper voice motion

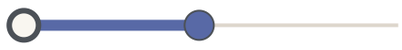


6 Tritone — A4/d5

Example: C4 → F♯4 / G♭4

searching · split · intriguing

contrast · chromatic voice leading



7 Perfect fifth — P5

Example: C4 → G4

resonant · broad · open

open fifths · bass framework



8 Minor sixth — m6

Example: C4 → A♭4

expressive · wide · intimate

melodic reach · inverted M3



9 Major sixth — M6

Example: C4 → A4

singing · gentle · expansive

lyrical leaps · inverted m3



10 Minor seventh — m7

Example: C4 → B♭4

spacious · soulful · unfinished

seventh-chord color · wide leap



11 Major seventh — M7

Example: C4 → B4

delicate · near-octave · edge

maj7 pads · long melodic reach



12 Perfect octave — P8

Example: C4 → C5

return · expansion · identity

octave doubling · register shifts



Make the palette your own

Your colors: _____

Your words: _____

The sounds have precise distances. The colors are invitations.

Together and sequentially can sound different. Register, timbre, harmony and culture matter.